Tiered Storage Infrastructure

Storage, Server and Application Levels

With the increasing volume and complexity of information that gets churned out these days, the need to optimise storage and retrieval becomes an important aspect to consider. In this article, the author sheds some light on each layer of a tiered storage infrastructure — storage, server and applications.

Today, information is being created faster than ever by businesses across the world. The information growth rate is not uniform across industry segments. In some verticals, growth follows a sedate pace, whereas an information explosion awaits other industries like financial services, health care, etc. In such a complex environment of information management, today's IT infrastructure managers face the challenge of enabling the right amount of infrastructure that can help organisations in leveraging information and creatively managing the data centres optimally. And all this needs to be achieved in the most economical way.

On the one hand is the non-linear growth of data, regulatory compliance and the decreasing cost of storage, and on the other is the impact of the industry slowdown. All of this has combined to further speed up the process of doing more with less. In order to keep up with these dynamics, IT managers are faced with the challenge of cutting IT budgets while risking the probability of not addressing business needs effectively, both from the resourcing as well as the infrastructure perspectives. Inadequacy in addressing business needs includes exposing business-critical data to risks such as loss of data, theft and downtime of business applications.

This is a pain point for the industry and can be addressed by designing a 'tier-ed infrastructure' model, which is a sub-set